

three column output for each file, the first column contain status, the second contains a 'c', if it is a configuration file or a space if isn't, and the final column contains the filename.

Uninstalling

To remove a package you need to use the -e option '`rpm -e <package name>`'. Before removing the package, rpm manager checks whether other packages that are dependent on one you are uninstalling. If so, it will print an error message and stop. To remove a package without dependency check, you will have to use option '`-nodeps`'.

Online search and download

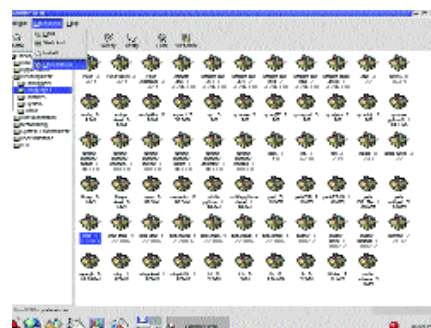
If you don't have rpms, then you need search and retrieve utilities such as rpmfind. As the name suggests, rpmfind is a program which helps you find rpms. If you execute a command such as, '`rpm gimp`', you get a list of files needed by the package. The tool rpmfind detects all the dependency information and provides you with the list of files, the size needed to install, and finally, helps you download the files.

By default, rpmfind assumes you know the name of the package, but if you don't, then you can use the '`-apropos`' option. With this option, you can specify a regular expression to find the package.

The result will be a link and summary about the package found. The search is basically a simple text search carried out using the filename and the description.

Gnome-RPM

If you do not like the command prompt interface, then you here is a graphical tool for you to add and remove packages. Gnome-rpm is a graphical version of the rpm command and is fully compatible with Gnome, a graphical X Window Interface. To access this tool go to **Main Menu > Run Program**, type '`gnorpm`' and press Run. The Gnome-RPM interface consists of a toolbar, a browser window for packages and a packages display area. The browser area on the

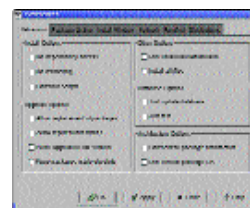


Querying checks whether the package is already installed

left pane contains package groups and sub-groups. On clicking the '+' sign besides the package, you can expand the group or the sub-group. To perform any operation—such as query, verify, install or uninstall—just select the package and press the corresponding button on the toolbar.

To configure the default behavior of the commands, you have to go to **Operations > Preferences**. Here, for each command, you can specify the default behavior under the Behavior tab.

Under the package listing tab you can specify the way packages will be displayed. In the Install Window tab, you can specify the default location to search for new rpms. In the Network tab you set the configuration for your proxy server (if any). In rpmfind tab you set details to be used while searching for new rpms. These include server address, download directory, etc. In the Distribution tab, you can specify rating as to which mirror you like to use.



Configure the default behaviour of the commands in the Behaviour tab

Package Formats

SRPMs

SRPMs are Source rpm files that do not contain a compiled program, instead they have source files. rpm files are created from these source files. You may need SRPM files if you are unable to get the compiled version, or if there are in compatibilities between the architecture and the distributions of the compiled version.

How do I install it?

First, you have to get the source rpm file for the package you wish to install. Generally the file format for these files is '`.src.rpm`'. You need to create a new binary package for the source code. To do so, execute using the `--rebuild` option; '`rpm --rebuild <package name>.src.rpm`'. The rebuild process creates the package file in the '`/usr/src/redhat/RPMS/i386`' by default. The architecture may differ from configuration to configuration. Go to the folder and proceed with the installation

of the new package.

dotDEB

dotDEB (or .deb) files, represent packages in Debian Linux. The purpose of these files is similar to that of .rpm files used to distribute installable packages. Debian packages can be converted to Red Hat, or Slackware packages using freely available tools such as Alien. The main debian programs you need to get are: dpkg-dev, debmake, debhelper and debconf.

Get these from <http://www.debian.org/distrib/packages>.

Slackware

Slackware packages consist of .rgz files. It is easy to maintain the packages, as Slackware has a good interface to help the packaging using pkgtool. Alternatively, you can use command-line utilities such as installpkg, removepkg, upgradepkg, makepkg and explodpkg. Apart from these utilities, it also has an rpm2targz utility to convert Red Hat rpms.

RPMs

Red Hat brings along with it a Package Management tool to manage default applications, or tools that are bundled with the Red Hat distribution CD. This tool helps in easy installation, or removal of applications. To manage applications other than those mentioned in the Package Manager, you will have to use the Command-line rpm tool, or some other third party tool.

To access the built-in package manager of Red Hat, go to **System Settings > Packages**. Now, to add or remove an appli-

